SAMUEL BOUZANQUET

Game Designer • Systems • Narrative

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INTRO

Hey, I'm Samuel! I'm a 25 year old game designer who spent the last four years as the Lead Game Designer at PLAYA3ULL GAMES, where I designed or overhauled four of our games.

I've recently graduated from my Bachelor of Games Development, and I'm looking to jump into a different area of the gaming and design industry. Gaming and creative design are by far my biggest passions!

SKILLS

DESIGN

Systems design
Mechanics design and improvement
Level design
Balancing
Game Design Documents
Feedback and QA triage
Competitor research
Theming and lore
Art direction

TOOLS

Unity
C#
Unreal Engine 5
Blueprint
C++
Perforce
Miro
draw.io
Excalidraw
Monday
3D modelling, rigging and animation

HOW I WORK

- Passionate - I always want to do a task to the best of my ability, and love learning better ways to do it
- A planner and prepper, but can improvise when needed
- Punctual, respectful, honest and upfront
- A creative problem solver
- Always listen to feedback, and ask for help when unsure
- Can lead a team, work independently or be a good team player

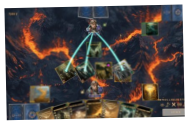
EXPERIENCE

Lead Game Designer & Communications Manager

PLAYA3ULL GAMES Early 2022 - Mid 2026

I started PLAYA3ULL GAMES with my family in late 2021, and it launched in early 2022. It's a gaming company that uses crypto as its primary income and "play to earn" source, which presented its own unique design challenges and considerations. I was in charge of our games' designs and theming - and as I gained more experience and education, more and more of the technical side too.

I fully designed ORDINEM (a trading card game battler) and WAR OF STEEL (a 3rd person mech battle royale). I also redesigned and overhauled STARVIN MARTIAN (a Mars-colony farming game), and designed and improved NEXUS (a 3rd person MOBA shooter).


ORDINEM


STARVIN MARTIAN


WAR OF STEEL


NEXUS

This involved:

- **Lead Game Designer.** I designed ORDINEM's mechanics and cards from the ground up. For WAR OF STEEL, I designed the main mechanics and levels before it was paused in alpha. I also led the redesign and development of STARVIN MARTIAN and NEXUS.
- **Vision holder.** I created and owned the theming, lore and art style for each game. I kept the whole team and myself aligned to these design decisions through weekly meetings, Discord and Monday (our task manager).
- **Balance and feedback.** I owned game balance (in most cases). I triaged feedback from players and devs, and vetted and prioritised QA bugs.
- **Documentation.** I wrote and maintained the Game Design Documents - the source of truth for every game's mechanics.
- **Research.** I was the sole researcher before development started on each game. I played and studied MTG Arena, Hearthstone, Legends of Runeterra, Riftbound, Gods Unchained, Eternal, Titanfall 2, Armored Core VI: Fires of Rubicon, Predecessor, Paragon: The Overprime, League of Legends, Apex Legends, Fortnite, Township and many more. This let me find references, explain concepts and validate ideas.
- **Hands-on polish.** For ORDINEM and STARVIN MARTIAN, I got into the engine (Unity) myself to improve the gameplay experience, and implemented some of my own balancing and other small tweaks. I used Perforce for version control.
- **Communications.** I was in charge of communication with investors, customers and other invested parties. I also met with investors and the other founders to decide on each game's vision.

Want to see what I specifically did on each of these games (with examples)? Click a game above, or head to my website - sambou2501.github.io/PortfolioWebsite/projects/

VR Developer (post-graduate opportunity)
Holmesglen Institute Late 2023 - Early 2024

Created a working VR relaxation experience in Unity as part of Holmesglen's post-graduate opportunities. It's set on a ship, where hums and lights slowly help the player relax over a few minutes - to fall asleep or meditate.

- I did all of the C# coding for the experience's systems and sequencing, as well as almost all of the implementation of assets into the level.
- I did a lot of the research - finding ideas and references, and sourcing sounds and images to help the player relax.
- I did a large portion of the testing and iteration myself - creating builds, putting them on the Oculus and playing.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Games Development
CG Spectrum 2025 - Mid 2026

- Used Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprint and C++) to create multiple game levels, systems and experiences.
- Researched, designed, built, tested and iterated on a medieval 3D zombie horde shooter level over multiple months, delivering a finished mini-demo.
- Took my capstone, a framework of modular functionality, through the same process over multiple months to create a genuinely useful tool.
- Technically designed and presented many systems using visualisation tools like Miro, draw.io and Excalidraw.
- Wrote documentation for other people to read and use.

See what I specifically did on the Zombie Horde level - sambou2501.github.io/PortfolioWebsite/projects/zorde/ and on my Framework Capstone - sambou2501.github.io/PortfolioWebsite/projects/capstone/

Diploma of Information Technology (Game Art, Design and Programming)
Holmesglen Institute Early 2022 - Mid 2023

- Shipped our own VR game with a student team as our capstone. The player is a shooter defending against bugs encroaching from all sides.
- Was in charge of that team's game design and documentation, and managed everyone's roles and jobs.
- Coded multiple full systems in C#, most notably health, enemy spawning and enemy AI behaviour.
- Modelled, textured, rigged and animated my own Jorōgumo-inspired enemy for a small game demo.
- Used Unity to implement models, animations, textures and shaders, put together entire levels and create builds.
- Researched and designed the enemies and mechanics for each game, and used version control to back up and track the project.

VCE
Vermont Secondary College Class of 2019

Completed VCE with an ATAR of 89 (Psychology, English Language, Further Maths, Biology, and Health and Human Development).

JOY Radio Training Course
June - August 2018

Radio broadcast training covering on-air presentation, interviewing, studio operation, media law and digital editing.

VOLUNTEERING & COMMUNITY

Radio Presenter - Youth In Control (YIC)
JOY 94.9 Late 2017 - 2020

I hosted YIC, a weekly show, for a few years. I planned the shows, wrote scripts, prepped interview guests and edited the podcasts.

Event Volunteer
Minus18 Late 2017 - 2020

I helped run many of their events - setting up and packing down halls, running large merchandise stalls and social events, and leading other volunteers.

Organiser and Founder
Rainbow Formal, Noosa Heads
July 2017 - October 2017

I was one of the two main organisers of Queensland's first LGBTI+ formal for school students. I helped with promotion, resources and attendees, and helped plan the event and volunteer roles.

Outside of games, I love reading books, dancing, and studying and learning about the sciences. References are available on request.